

Big Kid Bed Transition Chaos — Action Checklist

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VERIFY READINESS BEFORE TRANSITIONING

- ☐ **Verify Readiness Before Transitioning:** Measure your child's height to confirm they reach 35 inches or their crib rail sits below chest level when standing, as this indicates the AAP-recommended safety threshold for transitioning out of a crib.
- ☐ **Verify Readiness Before Transitioning:** Observe whether your toddler is making regular attempts to climb out of the crib rather than occasional incidents, because consistent escape attempts signal the crib has become a safety risk rather than a sleep aid.
- ☐ **Verify Readiness Before Transitioning:** Confirm no major life disruptions are occurring, including active potty training in progress, a recent home move or renovation, or recent changes to childcare or work arrangements that could compete for your toddler's attention.
- ☐ **Verify Readiness Before Transitioning:** If a new sibling is on the way, schedule the transition to begin no earlier than 8 weeks before the due date or wait until the baby is at least 3 months old to prevent a double disruption to family sleep.

CHILDPROOF ROOM BEFORE NIGHT ONE

- ☐ **Childproof Room Before Night One:** Install door locks or bolt locks on the bedroom door at the top or bottom where your toddler cannot reach them, preventing unsupervised wandering into hallways or other rooms during the night.
- ☐ **Childproof Room Before Night One:** Anchor all tall furniture, bookshelves, and dressers to the walls using anti-tip straps, because a newly mobile toddler will test the bed and surrounding furniture during nighttime exploration.
- ☐ **Childproof Room Before Night One:** Install safety gates at the top and bottom of any stairs in the home and cover all electrical outlets with tamper-resistant caps before the first night in the bed.
- ☐ **Childproof Room Before Night One:** Remove all choking-hazard small objects, secure window blind cords, and relocate medications or cleaning products to locked cabinets, because a toddler with room access will investigate everything within reach at night.

EXECUTE THE REGRESSION RECOVERY PLAN

- ☐ **Execute the Regression Recovery Plan:** Prepare a consistent, pre-planned response for nighttime wake-ups before the transition begins, because improvising responses leads parents to make inconsistent decisions that extend the regression beyond the normal 2-week adjustment period.
 - ☐ **Execute the Regression Recovery Plan:** Establish and commit to clear boundaries from night one about where your child will sleep, avoiding the trap of allowing them into the parental bed at 1am when you're exhausted and desperate.
 - ☐ **Execute the Regression Recovery Plan:** Refrain from making threats or promises about the transition that you cannot enforce, because empty consequences destroy your credibility and make subsequent nights significantly harder to manage.
 - ☐ **Execute the Regression Recovery Plan:** Have a prepared, age-appropriate response ready when your toddler asks to return to the crib, using language like "big kids sleep in big kid beds" that affirms the transition without inviting negotiation.
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Companion to the full guide in your Lemon Squeezy library — check off each item as you complete it.